a "world-wide Jewish people" or the proposition that Israel had the right in any way to represent Diaspora Jews.[13]

The public position of the *New York Times* and its publisher, Arthur Hays Sulzberger, resembled that of the American Council for Judaism. In the 1940s, the *Times* already stood at the pinnacle of American journalism. Owned by a prominent Jewish family of German extraction, it proved to be hypersensitive to charges of any special pleading on behalf of Jews. There was, for example, strong opposition by Sulzberger to the highlighting of the mass extermination of European Jewry in the columns of the *Times*. Insecurity about American antisemitism, especially after Hitler's rise to power, clearly exacerbated the *Times* syndrome of consistently underplaying Jewish suffering, universalizing the Jews' plight, and avoiding open confrontations with antisemites.

As Laurel Leff has shown, the *Times* buried reports on the mass murder of European Jewry deep inside the paper. At the same time, Sulzberger himself continued to attack the idea of a Jewish State in Palestine.[14] Throughout the war years and until 1948, he broadly supported British anti-Zionist policy. Like his friend Judah Magnes, he advocated a binational state (with an Arab majority) rather than a Jewish homeland; and he persisted in denying that the Jews were a "people" in terms virtually identical to traditional Reform anti-Zionists. Nevertheless, American Jewish anti-Zionism appeared to have lost much of its earlier force.[15] It was increasingly clear that the ideological premises behind it had been severely eroded by the genocidal fury of Nazi antisemitism. The Holocaust starkly exposed the urgency of a refuge for a persecuted and homeless Jewry in the DP camps of postwar Europe.

Not only the problem of the Holocaust survivors, but also the uprooting and expropriation of Jews from Arab lands in the late 1940s and early 1950s required immediate attention. The creation of Israel offered a practical solution to these acute refugee issues in the post-Shoah world. It continued to do so for the Soviet-Jewish exodus after 1970 (and then in the 1990s) as well as for the Jews of Ethiopia and other persecuted or harassed Jewish communities. Anti-Zionists, however, have willfully ignored these realities, focusing almost exclusively on the Palestinian *Naqba*. Jewish Israeli suffering, it would seem, interests them as little as Israel's success in maintaining a robust democracy, a prosperous economy, a technologically innovative society, and a vibrant modern culture.

Rather than address the achievements of Zionism, its Jewish "critics" prefer to focus on its alleged racism and apartheid. During the past two decades, there has been a striking return to pre-Shoah claims that Zionism entails an abandonment or even a betrayal of Jewish ethics and the Hebrew

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